

S.A.F.E.R

CONTRACTING SERVICES PTY LTD

*Complete solutions,
trusted service.*

WARRANTY PROCEDURES

What it covers, what it doesn't, and why any of this matters to you.

We understand that warranty documentation isn't exactly how most people choose to spend a Tuesday. We've done our best to make this worth your time — it's plain-language, reasonably brief, and may save you a meaningful amount of money.

Please do read it. Not because we're asking nicely (though we are), but because understanding how warranty service works puts you in a considerably stronger position if something ever goes wrong.

This document exists for one reason: so that if something unexpected comes up during your warranty visit, nobody is caught off guard — including us. The good news is that as a customer who has engaged licensed professionals, you are already surrounded by a layer of warranties, licences, and statutory protections — from the manufacturer, your installer, and the law itself. Our job is simply to help you understand where each one applies.

🔧 1. Who We Are & Why the Manufacturer Trusts Us

Before we explain how warranty service works, it's worth knowing who is coming to your door — and why the manufacturer chose us to do it.

S.A.F.E.R Contracting Services is contracted directly by the manufacturer to diagnose and repair their products. This isn't a casual arrangement — it's one built on years of specialised training, rigorous licensing, and consistent audit performance.

We complete bi-annual training with the manufacturer's own in-house engineers, keeping our team current with every product, revision, and known fault pattern. When the manufacturer sends us, they are sending a team they have personally trained, tested, and trusted with their brand.

Our qualifications include:

- Fully Qualified Electrical Mechanic (Electrician) — Open Licence: authorised to diagnose, repair, design, install, service, and maintain all types of electrical systems.
- Refrigeration Mechanic (Refrigeration & Air Conditioning) — Open Licence: authorised to install, repair, design, service, and maintain mechanical refrigeration systems.
- Refrigerant Trading Licence: authorised to trade, charge, reclaim, add, and remove all types of refrigerants safely and in compliance with Australian regulations.
- All insurances held in full, appropriate to our licences and the full scope of our work.

Many installation contractors hold a licence to install a product — but are not licensed to diagnose or repair live electrical or refrigeration systems. That distinction matters. We hold the licences and insurances to do all of it.

🔍 2. What a Manufacturer Warranty Covers

Here's the good news first: if your system has developed a fault due to a failed component within the unit itself, that's exactly what we're here for — and it won't cost you a thing.

A manufacturer warranty covers the product — specifically, components that form part of the manufactured unit itself. If something inside the unit fails under normal use, we find it, we fix it, and the manufacturer picks up the tab.

What is covered:

- Internal components that form part of the manufactured unit.
- Connections and cables that are integral to and supplied as part of the product.

Where it gets more nuanced — and where we want to be upfront with you — is when a fault lies outside the product itself:

- Interconnecting cables, pipes, drains, or conduits that are not part of the product — these are third-party components and carry their own manufacturer's warranty.
- Flared joints, welded connections, or any field-made joints — these are workmanship items, not product items.
- Installation-related faults of any kind.

If we open a job and the fault lies outside the product — in the installation, pipework, cabling, or a field join — the manufacturer will not authorise payment for that work.

We will always tell you this before any further work proceeds. Responsibility in these cases depends on what's actually behind the fault — sometimes that's your installer, under their workmanship warranty; other times it's a different product's manufacturer (for interconnecting cables, pipes, or conduits not supplied by us), or another party or circumstance entirely. Either way, it isn't something you need to absorb yourself — we'll tell you clearly which one applies to your situation, and give you everything you need to take it to the right place.

🚫 3. Things Outside Everyone's Warranty

There is a third category worth knowing about — faults that fall outside both the manufacturer's warranty and your installer's workmanship warranty. These are situations where external factors have caused or contributed to the fault, and no warranty of any kind is designed to cover them.

Common examples include:

- Vermin or rodent damage — chewed cables, wiring, insulation, or components caused by pest activity inside or around the unit.
- Storm, flood, or water ingress damage — where external weather events have affected the system.
- Power surge or incorrect voltage damage — caused by grid fluctuations, lightning strike, or incorrect supply.
- Corrosion from coastal or corrosive environments — salt air and chemical exposure accelerate deterioration beyond normal wear.
- Unauthorised repairs or modifications — any prior work carried out on the system by an unlicensed or unapproved party.
- Damage from neglect or lack of maintenance — systems that have not been serviced in accordance with manufacturer recommendations.

We will always identify and document these clearly so you know exactly what you're dealing with and why.

If pest or vermin activity has been identified, we recommend contacting your pest control provider. Many pest control companies offer warranties on their treatments that may be directly relevant to your situation — and some insurers may also cover this type of damage under home and contents policies.

Similarly, power surge damage is often claimable through your electricity provider or home insurer. We are happy to provide documentation to support any such claim.

🌿 4. Your Installer's Warranty & Your Broader Rights

Your installer carries their own workmanship warranty — separate from the manufacturer's warranty and entirely independent of us. In most cases, where we identify a fault that lies in the installation rather than the product, that cost properly belongs with your installer under their workmanship obligations.

Depending on who installed your system, the value of the work, and your location, you may also have statutory protections through bodies such as the QBCC, the Electrical Safety Office, NSW Fair Trading, or the Building Commission NSW. On top of that, Australian Consumer Law provides automatic rights regardless of who did the work or what it cost.

We are not the right people to advise you on which statutory protections apply to your specific situation — that depends on factors we may not be across.

What we can do is provide you with a clear, written report of our findings so you have something concrete to take to your installer, your relevant regulator, or your own legal advice if needed.

Installer workmanship warranties are entirely dependent on the individual installing contractor — their duration, scope, and conditions vary from business to business. We are not in a position to advise on what your installer's warranty covers or for how long, as this is an arrangement between you and them directly.

We recommend taking two minutes to either check your original installation documentation or give your installer a quick call to confirm what is covered and for how long.

It's a conversation worth having before something goes wrong rather than after — and most reputable installers will be happy to walk you through it.

We always recommend keeping your original installation paperwork, warranty documentation, and any compliance certificates your installer provided. They matter more than most people realise — usually only once something goes wrong.

5. Parts Retention, Auditing & Why It Benefits You

We are required to retain all removed warranty parts for a minimum of six months. We are also subject to regular audits by the manufacturer and must return parts for independent testing on a consistent basis.

We mention this not as a footnote, but because it directly benefits you.

This process exists so the manufacturer can analyse failure patterns, improve future products, and validate warranty claims with real evidence.

Every part we return, every audit we pass, contributes to better products for future customers — and sometimes reveals systemic issues that lead to improved components or extended remedies for existing owners.

It also means our work is independently verified. Regularly. We're comfortable with that.

6. What We Do Not Repair

We are here to repair the product. We do not carry out repairs to items outside of it — cables, pipework, drains, fittings, and installation work are outside our scope under the manufacturer's authority.

There is, however, a practical upside worth noting:

We are frequently able to identify installation faults that your original installer may have missed, or may not have the current availability or licence to address themselves.

Think of it as a second set of highly qualified eyes on your system — eyes that happen to carry open electrical and refrigeration licences. We find the fault. We document it clearly. And if it isn't ours to fix, we tell you exactly who it belongs to.

This is not a limitation of our service. It is simply how warranty service is correctly structured — and in practice, it often works in your favour.

7. If We Find Something Outside the Warranty

We will always tell you as early as we possibly can. Our job is not to rack up a bill; it's to find the fault and tell you honestly where it sits.

There's one thing worth being upfront about, because we'd rather you hear it from us now than feel blindsided later: diagnosing whether something is a warranty fault is itself chargeable work if it turns out not to be. The initial visit and first hour of diagnostic time — covering labour, travel, and admin — are what determine warranty status in the first place, so that part can't be confirmed with you in advance, simply because nobody (including us) knows the outcome until that work is done. Any consumables genuinely needed to carry out that diagnosis are billed separately at set prices, for the same reason (more on that below). This is exactly what you agreed to in our terms and conditions at the time of booking, and these are the costs that apply either way the diagnosis lands.

Where our commitment kicks in is what happens the moment that's confirmed. We don't keep working on the unit once a fault is identified as non-warranty — we pack up (or we're already packed up), let you know clearly what we found, and that visit gets billed in line with what's set out in our terms, regardless of what you decide to do next. We don't carry out repairs or fit parts on the spot for a non-warranty issue. If a repair is something we can help with, we'll put together a quote and send that through separately, so you've got time to consider it properly rather than deciding on the spot. If you accept that quote, the repair is booked and billed as its own separate job — it isn't an extension of the diagnostic visit you've already paid for.

To be clear, our quote is never your only option. The written findings are yours to do with as you see fit — get a second opinion, take them to your installer, or get other repairers to quote against the same diagnosis. You've paid for the diagnosis; what you do with it afterwards is entirely up to you.

Some consumables — refrigerant, nitrogen, and similar — are sometimes required just to safely test, isolate, or assess the system. These are charged separately at set prices, in addition to the visit fee — they're not optional extras we pause to ask about, because the diagnosis genuinely can't happen without them. We're always happy to tell you exactly what was used, the cost, and why — just ask, any time.

If the fault lies outside the manufacturer's warranty, we will clearly explain why, put it in writing, and give you the information you need to take it further — to your installer, a regulator, or anyone else. The situations where charges apply are:

- The fault lies in the installation, interconnecting components, or field-made joins.
- The fault results from external damage, inappropriate use, or third-party interference.
- Work is required that falls outside the scope of the manufacturer's authorisation.

Responsibility for these costs depends on what actually caused the fault, not on a single default answer. Where the fault traces back to the installation, pipework, cabling, or a field-made join, that responsibility sits with your installer under their workmanship warranty. Where it traces back to something else — pest damage, a power surge, storm or water damage, or lack of maintenance, for example — it sits with whichever warranty or insurance actually covers that cause, whether that's a pest controller's treatment warranty, your electricity provider, your home insurer, or another party entirely. We'll always tell you clearly which category your situation falls into, and give you a written report so you have something solid to take to the right place.

If you don't agree with our findings, we're genuinely happy to come back and take another look — but worth knowing upfront that a re-

attendance is treated as a new booked visit in its own right, with its own service fee. We'd rather you know that going in than assume a second look is automatically included.

What you can rely on: no escalating, after-the-fact invoice for work you didn't know was happening. Once a fault's confirmed as non-warranty, we stop there — no repairs, no parts, nothing further on the day. You're billed for the visit, and if a repair's on the table, you'll see a proper quote afterwards, with time to make your own call on it. That's a commitment, not a footnote.

⚖️ 8. One Thing Worth Knowing About Loss Beyond the Repair Itself

Most warranty visits are straightforward — we diagnose, we fix or refer, everyone moves on. Occasionally, a fault causes knock-on effects beyond the unit itself: a few uncomfortable nights without air conditioning, food affected by a fridge or cool room outage, a tenant frustrated by the wait, or a business disrupted while a system's down.

We understand those impacts are real and inconvenient. Where they happen, our responsibility is to diagnose and repair the unit itself correctly and in good faith — it doesn't extend to compensating for losses that follow on from the system being faulty, such as loss of use, loss of stock, tenant or business disruption, or similar flow-on impacts. This is standard across the industry and reflects that we don't control how, when, or under what conditions a system was installed, used, or maintained before we ever arrive.

This doesn't affect any rights you have that can't be excluded under Australian Consumer Law — those always stand, regardless of anything in this document or our terms and conditions.

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